COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, TOWEL, BACKHAUS

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-F-42019 and Federal Specification GG-F-620 which are cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers two sizes of forceps used for clamping towels to skin during surgical procedures.

Salient characteristics:

General. The forceps shall be of the Backhaus design and of the following sizes and lengths:

SIZE	Length (inches)
1	3-1/2
2	5-1/4

Material. The forceps shall be fabricated from class 4, type 420 martensitic corrosion resistant steel in accordance with ASTM F899.

Hardness. The forceps shall have a Rockwell Hardness (HRC) scale of 40 to 45 when tested in accordance with ASTM E18 or E92 whichever is applicable. Conversion of hardness values shall be in accordance with ASTM E140.

Style, design and dimensions. The forceps shall be in accordance with Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing No. 20230 for style, design and dimensions.

Finish. The forceps shall have a mirror, satin or matte finish.

Passivation. The forceps shall be properly passivated.

Corrosion resistance. The forceps shall show no signs of corrosion or plating of copper when tested in accordance with ASTM F1089.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

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Identification marking and labeling. The forceps shall be legibly marked with the contractor's name or trademark and the word "stainless". Foreign manufactured forceps shall bear the name of the country of origin.

Workmanship. The forceps shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One forceps, of the size specified, constitutes one unit.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as specified herein. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one forceps. Sampling shall be Inspection level II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 1.0.

Examination. Examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

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Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps. Sampling shall be Inspection level S-2 with an AQL of 1.0.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerance specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

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Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	Item Identification	SIZE
6515-00-320-4590	FORCEPS, TOWEL, BACKHAUS, 3-1/2 inches.	1
6515-00-320-4600	FORCEPS, TOWEL, BACKHAUS, 5-1/4 inches.	2

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-5205

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8 In block 1, both the document number and revis letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorizatior waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements

	1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)

3. DOCUMENT TITLE

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5 REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME	b. ORGANIZATION

c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)

8 PREPARING ACTIVITY

a NAME	b TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON
Defense Personnel Support Center	(215) 737-2870	444-2870

c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT.
ATTN: MSE 2800 S. 20th Street Philadelphia, PA 19145	Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

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